

Word family: **perfume / perfumes / perfumed / perfuming / perfumery / perfumer**

Base word: perfume

Part of speech: mainly **noun**, also **verb**

Related forms:

* **perfume** (n.) — 香水；香氣；芬芳

* **perfume** (v.) — 使……帶香氣；使……充滿香味

* **perfumed** (adj./participle) — 有香味的；加了香料的

* **perfumery** (n.) — 香水製造業；香水店 / 香水製作藝術

* **perfumer** (n.) — 調香師；香水製造者

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **wear perfume**

* **put on perfume**

* **a bottle of perfume**

* **strong perfume**

* **light perfume**

* **the perfume of flowers**

* **perfumed soap**

* **perfumed air**

* **perfume the room**

* **perfume industry**

* **perfume counter**

* **perfume bottle**

* **perfumer**

* **perfumery**

Meaning in this passage

> So I knew that buying **perfume**, clothes, or skincare products would probably feel a bit ordinary.

Here, **perfume** means:

a fragrant liquid worn on the body to give a pleasant smell — 香水

中文翻譯：

所以我知道，如果我買**香水**、衣服或者護膚品，感覺大概都會有點普通。

So here:

perfume = 塗或噴在身上、用來產生香味的香水產品

1. **perfume (香水) — 香水**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Buying **perfume** would probably feel a bit ordinary.

買**香水**大概會顯得有點普通。

Practice 2

> She received a bottle of **perfume** for her birthday.

她生日收到了一瓶**香水**。

Practice 3

> He bought his mother some **perfume**.

他買了一些**香水**送給媽媽。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****perfume = 一種帶有香味、通常噴或塗在身體上的液體產品****

2. **wear perfume — 搽 / 噴香水**

Practice 1

> She rarely **wears perfume**.

她很少**搽香水**。

Practice 2

> He noticed that she was **wearing perfume**.

他留意到她**噴了香水**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****wear perfume = 把香水塗或噴在身上****

3. ****put on perfume — 搽 / 噴香水****

Practice 1

> She ****put on some perfume**** before dinner.

她晚飯前****噴了一點香水****。

Practice 2

> I forgot to ****put on perfume**** this morning.

我今早忘了****搽香水****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****put on perfume = 把香水噴或塗到身上****

4. ****a bottle of perfume — 一瓶香水****

Practice 1

> He bought her ****a bottle of perfume****.

他買了****一瓶香水****給她。

Practice 2

> The ****perfume bottle**** was beautifully designed.

那個****香水瓶****設計得很漂亮。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a bottle of perfume = 一瓶裝着香水的產品****

5. ****perfume (香氣 ; 芬芳) — 香味 ; 芳香****

A second noun sense.

Practice 1

> The **perfume of the flowers** filled the garden.

花朵的**香氣**瀰漫整個花園。

Practice 2

> A sweet **perfume** came from the trees.

樹木散發出甜美的**芳香**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****perfume = pleasant natural or artificial fragrance in the air****

中文：

****令人愉快的香氣或芬芳****

6. ****the perfume of flowers — 花香****

Practice 1

> We could smell the **perfume of roses**.

我們聞到玫瑰的**花香**。

Practice 2

> The evening air carried the **perfume of jasmine**.

晚風吹來茉莉的**香氣**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****the perfume of X = X 散發出的宜人香氣****

7. ****perfume (verb : 使.....有香味) — 使帶香氣 ; 使芬芳****

Practice 1

> The flowers **perfumed the room**.

花朵的香味**令整個房間充滿芬芳**。

Practice 2

> Lavender **perfumed the evening air**.

薰衣草香氣**瀰漫晚間空氣**。

MCQ-ready definition:

perfume something = 使某個地方或物件充滿香氣

8. **be perfumed with — 帶有……香氣**

Practice 1

> The air was **perfumed with roses**.

空氣中**瀰漫着玫瑰香氣**。

Practice 2

> The room was **perfumed with lavender**.

房間裏**充滿薰衣草香味**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be perfumed with X = 帶有或充滿 X 的香氣

9. **perfumed (有香味的 ; 加香料的) — 有香味的 ; 芳香的**

Practice 1

> She bought **perfumed soap**.

她買了**有香味的肥皂**。

Practice 2

> The drawer contained **perfumed paper**.

抽屜裏放着**帶香味的紙張**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****perfumed = specially made to have a pleasant smell****

中文：

****特別加入香味或本身帶有芬芳的****

10. ****perfumed soap / lotion — 香味肥皂 / 香味乳液****

Practice 1

> Strongly ****perfumed soap**** irritates her skin.

香味很濃的****香皂****會刺激她的皮膚。

Practice 2

> This lotion is lightly ****perfumed****.

這款乳液只有淡淡的****香味****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****perfumed product = 加入香料、帶有明顯香氣的產品****

11. ****perfumery (香水製造；調香藝術) — 香水製作；調香業****

Practice 1

> France has a long tradition of ****perfumery****.

法國有悠久的****香水製作 / 調香傳統****。

Practice 2

> She studied the art of ****perfumery****.

她學習****調香藝術****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****perfumery = the art, craft, or business of making perfume****

中文：

****製作香水的藝術、技術或行業****

12. ****perfumery (香水店 / 香水部門) — 香水店；香水專櫃****

A less common retail use.

Practice 1

> They visited a traditional ****perfumery****.

他們參觀了一間傳統****香水店****。

Practice 2

> The department store has a large ****perfumery section****.

這間百貨公司有很大的****香水專櫃區****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****perfumery = a shop or department specializing in perfumes and related products****

中文：

****專門售賣香水及相關產品的商店或部門****

13. ****perfumer — 調香師****

Practice 1

> The ****perfumer**** created a new floral scent.

那位****調香師****創製了一款新的花香香氣。

Practice 2

> A skilled ****perfumer**** can identify hundreds of ingredients.

熟練的****調香師****可以辨認數百種香料。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****perfumer = a person who creates, blends, or manufactures perfumes****

中文：

****設計、調配或製造香水的人****

14. ****perfume counter — 香水專櫃****

Practice 1

> She tried several fragrances at the ****perfume counter****.

她在****香水專櫃****試了幾款香味。

Practice 2

> The ****perfume counter**** is on the ground floor.

****香水專櫃****在地下。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****perfume counter = 百貨公司或商店中專門售賣香水的櫃位****

15. ****strong / light perfume — 濃香 / 淡香****

Practice 1

> I find that ****perfume**** too strong.

我覺得那款****香水味太濃****。

Practice 2

> She prefers a ****light perfume****.

她喜歡較****清淡的香水****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****strong/light perfume = 香味濃烈 / 清淡的香水****

Important distinction 1: **perfume vs fragrance**

perfume

can mean:

- * the actual scented product
- * a pleasant smell

fragrance

broader and often more neutral/elegant:

- * pleasant smell
- * scented product category

> a bottle of perfume

一瓶香水

> a floral fragrance

花香香氣

In retail, **fragrance** can be an umbrella term for perfume products.

Important distinction 2: **perfume vs scent**

scent

broader:

- * pleasant smell
- * distinctive smell
- * animal/human trail detectable by smell

perfume

more specifically pleasant fragrance or fragrance product.

> the scent of rain

雨的氣味

> the perfume of roses

玫瑰的芬芳

So not every ****scent**** is perfume.

Important distinction 3: ****perfume vs smell****

****smell****

neutral umbrella word; can be pleasant or unpleasant.

****perfume****

specifically pleasant fragrance.

> a strange smell

奇怪氣味

> a delicate perfume

淡雅香氣

Important distinction 4: ****perfume vs aroma****

****aroma****

especially associated with food and drink:

* coffee

* bread

* wine

****perfume****

especially flowers, cosmetics, fragrant air.

> aroma of coffee

咖啡香氣

> perfume of roses

玫瑰芬芳

There can be overlap, but typical collocations differ.

Important distinction 5: **perfume vs cologne**

perfume

broad everyday category; can also refer to more concentrated fragrance products.

cologne

a lighter fragrance formulation in traditional usage.

In everyday speech, people sometimes use these labels loosely, so learners should avoid assuming they are perfect synonyms.

Important distinction 6: **perfume vs deodorant**

perfume

adds pleasant fragrance.

deodorant

reduces or masks body odour.

A deodorant can be scented, but its primary function differs.

Important distinction 7: **perfume noun vs verb**

Noun

> She bought **perfume**.

她買了香水。

Verb

> Flowers ****perfumed the room****.

花香瀰漫房間。

The verb does ****not**** usually mean “spray perfume on yourself” in ordinary modern English.

For that, say:

> put on perfume

> wear perfume

Important distinction 8: ****perfumed vs fragrant****

****perfumed****

often suggests fragrance has been intentionally added.

****fragrant****

simply means pleasantly scented.

> perfumed soap

加了香料的肥皂

> fragrant flowers

芳香的花朵

Important distinction 9: ****perfume = product vs perfume = natural fragrance****

Product

> She bought some perfume.

她買了一些香水。

Fragrance

> the perfume of flowers

花的芬芳

These are distinct but closely related noun senses.

Important distinction 10: **perfume countability**

When referring to the substance generally:

> She wears **perfume**. ✓

Usually uncountable.

When referring to varieties/products:

> The shop sells several **perfumes**. ✓

Here **perfumes** means different kinds/brands/formulations.

So:

perfume = 香水這種物質

a perfume / perfumes = 一款 / 多款香水

16. **a perfume (某一款香水) — 一款香水**

Practice 1

> This is a new **perfume** from the brand.

這是該品牌新推出的**一款香水**。

Practice 2

> She tested three different **perfumes**.

她試了三款不同的**香水**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a perfume = one particular type or formulation of fragrance product

中文 :

****某一款特定的香水產品****

Important distinction 11: ****perfume vs aftershave****

****perfume****

primarily for fragrance.

****aftershave****

traditionally applied after shaving and may also have fragrance.

They can overlap commercially, but their core functions differ.

Family-extension note

****Perfume**** has two main modern semantic branches:

1. ****fragrance product****

- * wear perfume
- * bottle of perfume
- * perfume counter
- * a perfume

2. ****pleasant fragrance itself****

- * the perfume of flowers
- * perfume in the air

From the second sense comes the verb:

3. ****perfume = make fragrant****

- * flowers perfumed the room
- * air perfumed with jasmine

And the family develops into:

4. ****perfumed****

* perfumed soap
* perfumed lotion

5. **perfumery / perfumer**

* perfume-making craft/industry
* person who creates perfume

For your passage, the exact sense is straightforward:

perfume = 香水產品

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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perfume (product)	香水	fragrance product
wear perfume	搽 / 噴香水	use on body
put on perfume	搽 / 噴香水	apply fragrance
a bottle of perfume	一瓶香水	packaged product
a perfume	一款香水	particular formulation
perfumes	多款香水	different varieties
perfume (smell)	香氣；芬芳	pleasant fragrance
perfume of flowers	花香	natural fragrance
perfume (verb)	使帶香氣	make fragrant
be perfumed with	瀰漫着.....香味	filled with fragrance
perfumed	有香味的；加香料的	scented
perfumed soap	香皂 / 有香味的肥皂	scented product
perfumery	調香；香水業	perfume craft/business
perfumery (shop)	香水店 / 香水部門	retail
perfumer	調香師	perfume creator
perfume counter	香水專櫃	retail counter

For your original sentence

> So I knew that buying **perfume**, clothes, or skincare products would probably feel a bit ordinary.

Here:

perfume = 作為禮物購買的香水產品

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 所以我知道，如果我買**香水**、衣服或者護膚品，感覺大概都會有點普通。

There is a useful nuance here: **perfume** itself is not being described negatively. The speaker simply feels that, for this particular occasion, buying perfume would be a more **standard, conventional gift choice** than creating the handmade album.